

Soren Larsen

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SUMMARY

Product-minded AI and full-stack engineer who owns features end-to-end from user conversation through production deployment. Experience spans LLM-powered products, agentic systems, applied NLP, and forward-deployed product engineering across founding-stage startups, consulting, and academic research.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz – M.S. NLP (2024–2025), B.S. Computer Science (2019–2023)

Santa Cruz, CA

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, Bash, Dart, C/C++, Swift
- **AI / LLM Systems:** LangChain, LangGraph, LangSmith, RAG, prompt engineering, agentic systems, OpenAI API, Anthropic API, Google Gemini, sentence-transformers, FAISS, ChromaDB
- **Frameworks:** FastAPI, Flask, Express.js, Node.js, React, Next.js, Flutter
- **Data & Infra:** PostgreSQL, Firebase, Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, GCP
- **ML / NLP Research:** PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, evaluation frameworks (ARES, BFCL), information extraction, embeddings, NER
- **Developer Workflows:** Claude Code, Git, testing, debugging, rapid prototyping

EXPERIENCE

- **Founding Engineer (Contract)** Feb 2026 – Present
Levangie Laboratories *Remote*
 - **Product Engineering:** Independently conceptualized and delivered high-impact platform features, owning the full development cycle from direct user and customer conversations to production deployment.
 - **Performance & System Hardening:** Led critical initiatives optimizing system responsiveness and resource efficiency, including a 90%+ reduction in core latency and meaningful improvements in backend stability.
 - **Infrastructure & Operations:** Established internal engineering standards by building automated deployment pipelines, comprehensive testing frameworks, and monitoring tools to support high-velocity, reliable releases.
 - **Forward-Deployed Engineering:** Partner directly with users and customer-facing teammates to diagnose operational bottlenecks, moving from initial discovery to deployed technical solutions within rapid iteration cycles.
 - **Core Technologies:** Python (FastAPI), TypeScript (Next.js/React), PostgreSQL, Docker, Cloud Infrastructure (GCP).
- **Data Engineer, Full Stack Developer (Contract)** Jun 2025 – Feb 2026
Gray Whale *Remote*
 - **AI Evaluation & Benchmarking:** Designed and executed comparative retrieval evaluations using peer-reviewed methodology (ARES, NAACL 2024) on the KILT benchmark corpus; conducted function-calling assessments using the Berkeley Function Calling Leaderboard (BFCL).
 - **Agent System Prototypes:** Architected and built a multi-agent orchestration platform featuring planner-executor decoupling, dynamic agent discovery, and tiered query routing.
 - **Technical Evaluation:** Analyzed tool-calling and RAG workflows across latency, accuracy, and token usage to inform inference-cost and architectural decisions.
 - **Data Strategy:** Engineered pipelines transforming unstructured input into structured, model-ready formats, unblocking downstream research and evaluation cycles.
 - **Core Technologies:** Python, LangGraph, sentence-transformers, FAISS, BM25, OpenAI.
- **AI Engineer & Product Consultant (Contract)** May 2025 – Dec 2025
Onda Sports *Remote*
 - **Observability & Reliability:** Engineered an end-to-end tracing pipeline using LangSmith (Python / Google Gemini / GCP) to monitor model behavior, troubleshoot pipeline failures, and provide team visibility into inference costs and latency.
 - **R&D & Quality Assurance:** Designed and executed experiments across prompts and retrieval strategies to improve assistant response quality and grounding in real-time data.
 - **Product Strategy:** Contributed surfer-domain expertise to product design and feature discussions, informing technical decisions to align with the needs of the core user base.
- **Full-Stack Developer & Product Consultant** Apr 2024 – Jun 2025
Boardal *San Diego, CA*
 - **Mobile Product Development:** Built consumer-facing features end-to-end in Flutter and Firebase, including user-defined custom alerts with optimized push delivery, chat architecture enhancements, and dynamic content widgets; helped scale the platform to 20,000+ users.
 - **AI-Powered Internal Tooling:** Engineered a custom GPT workflow integrated with the Google Sheets API to generate outreach and marketing content for the summer intern team, standardizing messaging and accelerating content production.
 - **Core Technologies:** Flutter, Firebase (Firestore, Cloud Messaging), OpenAI API, iOS deployment.

PROJECTS

- **NLP for Research (No RAGrets) – M.S. NLP Capstone with CarbonBridge** May 2025 – Dec 2025
Baskin Engineering, UCSC — Industry-Sponsored Graduate Capstone — Featured by Santa Cruz Works
 - **Capstone Scope:** Built an industry-sponsored applied NLP system with CarbonBridge to support scientific literature triage, extraction, and vetting workflows.
 - **Industry Sponsorship:** Independently sourced and secured CarbonBridge as the project’s industry partner, shaping its real-world research focus and deployment context.
 - **Extraction & Knowledge Graph Pipelines:** Built GraphQL + Dgraph pipelines to extract, structure, and query claims, citations, units, baselines, and methodological red flags from scientific papers.
 - **LLM-Based Scientific Review:** Integrated LLM-powered parsing and critique modules to evaluate methodology rigor, citation quality, and reproducibility in domain-specific literature.
 - **Full-Stack Research Interface:** Built a full-stack application for reviewing papers and traversing graph-linked scientific claims and relationships.